

Turning Evidence Into Findings

From Notes to a Final Project

Today you turn data, sources, notebook outputs, and class labs into findings you can actually submit.

**PROJECT
FINDINGS**

Due May 26, 2026

Core distinction

Evidence is not the same thing as a finding

Evidence

A row, source, quote, chart, metric, or code output.

Finding

A claim you can support using that evidence.

Recommendation

A realistic action based on the finding.

Weak vs strong

A finding must be specific enough to defend

Weak: Security is important.

- Stronger: name the system or case
- Name the evidence
- Name the security issue
- Name the privacy or ethics concern

Coding path

For coding projects: explain what the code result means

- Do not only paste code
- Explain what table or chart shows
- Use two or three findings
- Write like a junior analyst, not like a programmer only

Essay path

For MLA essays: organize sources around an argument

- Do not summarize three sources separately
- Use sources to support one main claim
- Include security and privacy or ethics
- Use MLA citations and Works Cited

Sample project

Sample: security metrics daily summary

- Load the Week 12 CSV from GitHub
- Calculate a simple priority score
- Sort systems by review priority
- Turn the result into a short analyst report

Notebook walkthrough

What the sample code does

1

Load the CSV with pandas.

2

Create helper functions for points.

3

Apply the score to each row.

4

Sort by priority score.

5

Create one chart and summary table.

Report structure

A complete project report has predictable parts

- Question and background
- Dataset or source description
- Method or evidence
- Findings
- Recommendation
- Privacy or ethics concern
- Limitation

Today's lab

Lab goal: draft your findings outline

- Confirm your path and question
- List your evidence
- Draft two or three findings
- Draft a recommendation and limitation
- Submit a checkpoint paragraph

Work strategy

If you feel stuck, shrink the project

- Use one dataset instead of three
- Use one case instead of a whole industry
- Use two findings instead of five
- Make one recommendation you can defend

Checkpoint

Before you leave: submit the project skeleton

**Question + evidence +
findings +
recommendation**

- One paragraph explaining where you are
- One thing you finished today
- One thing you still need to do

Next class

Next class is mostly work time

- Bring your dataset, sources, or draft
- Bring your notebook if you are coding
- Bring citation information if you are writing
- Use the checklist to finish